

B.Ed. 1st Semester — Course 1.1.4

Language Across the Curriculum

Question Bank (2020–2024) with Model Answers

Repeated questions are listed once with all years noted. Group A ≈ 50 words, Group B ≈ 150 words (point form), Group C ≈ 300 words.

GROUP A — 2 Marks Each (any 5 asked, ~50 words)

1. What is 'Dialect'? (2020, 2022, 2024)

A dialect is a particular form of a language spoken by people of a specific region, social group, or community. It differs from the standard form in vocabulary, pronunciation, and grammar, while still being understood by other speakers of the same language.

2. What is 'questioning'? (2020)

Questioning is a teaching technique in which a teacher asks students questions to check understanding, encourage thinking, and promote discussion. It helps engage students actively in the lesson and reveals what they have understood or still need to learn.

3. Define the phrase 'speech community'. (2020)

A speech community is a group of people who share the same language or dialect and follow similar rules of speaking, understanding, and using language in social situations, allowing effective communication among its members.

4. Write the names of any two books written by Noam Chomsky. (2020, 2024)

Two books written by Noam Chomsky are: (i) *Syntactic Structures*, and (ii) *Aspects of the Theory of Syntax* — both foundational works explaining his ideas on generative grammar and language structure.

5. What is 'Language'? (2020)

Language is a structured system of communication using sounds, symbols, gestures, or written signs, following rules of grammar and meaning, that allows humans to express thoughts, feelings, and ideas, and to interact with one another socially.

6. Write two characteristics of written language. (2020)

(i) Written language is more permanent and can be stored, reread, and referred to later, unlike spoken words. (ii) It usually follows more formal grammar and structure, since there is no immediate feedback from a listener to clarify meaning.

7. What is 'expository text'? (2020, 2022)

Expository text is a type of writing that explains, informs, or describes facts and ideas about a topic in a clear, logical, and organized manner, such as textbooks, reports, or encyclopedia entries, without following a story structure.

8. Who is called the 'father of structural linguistics'? (2021)

Ferdinand de Saussure is called the father of structural linguistics. He introduced the idea of studying language as a structured system of signs, focusing on the relationships between its elements rather than just historical development.

9. What is 'Reading Proficiency'? (2021)

Reading proficiency refers to a person's ability to read text accurately, fluently, and with good comprehension, allowing them to understand, interpret, and use written information effectively for learning and daily life purposes.

10. Write two advantages of 'open-ended question'. (2021)

(i) It encourages students to think deeply and express ideas in their own words, promoting critical thinking. (ii) It reveals a fuller picture of a student's understanding, since answers are not limited to fixed choices.

11. What is 'narrative text'? / What are the general factors of narrative text? (2021, 2024)

Narrative text is a type of writing that tells a story, real or imaginary, usually including elements like characters, setting, plot, conflict, and resolution, arranged in a sequence of events to engage and inform the reader.

12. State two features of a 'Standard Language'. / What is standard language? (2021, 2024)

Standard language is the officially accepted, formal form of a language, used in education, media, and administration. Its features: (i) it follows fixed, uniform rules of grammar and spelling, and (ii) it is widely understood across different regions of speakers.

13. What is multilingualism? (2021)

Multilingualism refers to the ability of a person or community to use and understand more than one language. It is common in diverse countries like India, where people often speak their mother tongue along with other regional or national languages.

14. What do you mean by 'multiculturalism'? (2021)

Multiculturalism refers to the presence and acceptance of multiple different cultures, traditions, and identities within one society or group, such as a classroom, promoting respect, understanding, and equal value for diverse cultural backgrounds.

15. What is Schema? (2023)

A schema is an organized mental framework built from past knowledge and experience, which helps a person interpret, understand, and connect new information. In language learning, schema helps students relate new texts to what they already know.

16. What do you mean by lesson developing questions? (2023)

Lesson developing questions are questions asked by the teacher during a lesson to build on students' existing knowledge step by step, guiding them progressively towards new understanding and helping develop the lesson's content interactively.

17. Mention any four components of language. (2023)

The four main components of language are: (i) Phonology (sound system), (ii) Morphology (word formation), (iii) Syntax (grammar/sentence structure), and (iv) Semantics (meaning of words and sentences).

18. Write two features of home language. (2023)

(i) Home language is the language a child first learns and speaks at home with family, before formal schooling. (ii) It is usually informal and closely tied to the child's culture, emotions, and everyday personal life.

19. What is transactional text? Give one example. (2023)

Transactional text is writing used for practical, everyday communication between people, aimed at getting something done, such as requesting, informing, or instructing. Example: a formal letter of request or a text message asking someone to complete a task.

20. Mention two advantages of practicing multilingualism in the classroom. (2023)

(i) It helps students connect new learning to their home language, improving understanding of subject content. (ii) It

promotes respect for diverse cultures and languages, building an inclusive and confident classroom environment for all students.

21. Write two major roles of teacher in teaching social science. (2023)

(i) The teacher connects social science concepts to real-life examples, using appropriate language to make abstract ideas understandable. (ii) The teacher builds students' vocabulary and reading skills specific to social science, since the subject relies heavily on text-based learning.

22. What do you understand by the term 'Language across the Curriculum'? (2022)

Language across the Curriculum means using and developing language skills (reading, writing, speaking, listening) through all school subjects, not just the language class, since every subject requires understanding and using language to learn effectively.

23. What is meant by 'Classroom Discourse'? (2022)

Classroom discourse refers to the spoken or written communication that takes place between teachers and students, and among students themselves, during lessons. It includes the language used, patterns of interaction, and how knowledge is built and shared in class.

24. State two advantages of 'close ended questions'. (2022)

(i) They are quick and easy for students to answer, saving classroom time. (ii) Responses are simple to check and compare, making assessment more straightforward and objective for the teacher.

25. What is 'collaborative teaching'? (2022)

Collaborative teaching is an approach where two or more teachers work together to plan, teach, and assess a group of students. It combines different skills and perspectives, sharing responsibility for a richer overall learning experience.

26. What do you understand by language proficiency? (2022)

Language proficiency refers to a person's overall skill and ability to use a language correctly and effectively — in listening, speaking, reading, and writing — for communication and learning purposes.

27. What are the different types of questioning in the classroom? (2024)

Classroom questions can be of different types: **open-ended** (encourage detailed thinking, no fixed answer), **closed-ended** (short, specific, fixed answer), **probing** (dig deeper into a student's response), and **lesson-developing questions** (guide the lesson step by step).

28. What is 'multicultural classroom'? (2024)

A multicultural classroom is one where students come from different cultural, linguistic, and social backgrounds, learning together. Teachers in such classrooms need to respect and use this diversity to make learning inclusive for all students.

29. Mention two importance of 'school language'. (2024)

(i) School language (the formal language used for instruction) helps standardize learning and communication across all students in class. (ii) It builds students' academic vocabulary and formal language skills needed for higher studies and future careers.

GROUP B — 5 Marks Each (any 3 asked, ~150 words, point form)

1. Discuss about the nature of the reading process. (2020, 2022, 2024)

- Reading is not just recognizing words — it is an **active process** of constructing meaning from text.

- It involves **decoding** (recognizing letters/words) and **comprehension** (understanding meaning) working together.
- Reading uses the reader's **prior knowledge/schema** to connect with and interpret new text.
- It is a **purposeful** activity — readers read differently depending on their goal (skimming, detailed study, enjoyment).
- Reading develops through stages, moving from slow, effortful decoding in early learners to fast, fluent, automatic reading in skilled readers.
- Good reading also involves thinking critically about the text, not just passively absorbing it.

2. Write the significance of discussion as a strategy for language teaching. / How does 'discussion' facilitate learning in the classroom? / Role of teacher in using discussion. (2020, 2022, 2023)

- Discussion allows students to **practice speaking and listening skills** actively in a real communication context.
- It helps students **express and organize their thoughts** clearly using language.
- Group discussion exposes students to **different viewpoints**, broadening understanding of a topic.
- It builds **confidence** in using language, especially for shy or hesitant learners, through peer interaction.
- **Teacher's role:** guide the discussion by asking open-ended questions, ensuring all students participate, and gently correcting language errors without discouraging speech.

3. Mention the important role of a teacher in schema formation. (2020)

- The teacher **activates prior knowledge** before a new lesson, helping students connect new content to what they already know.
- The teacher provides **real-life examples, pictures, or stories** to help build new mental frameworks (schemas) for unfamiliar topics.
- The teacher helps students **organize information** logically, so it fits well into existing or new schemas.
- Regular **review and connection-making** between old and new lessons strengthens schema development over time, improving comprehension and retention.

4. Discuss the relation between curriculum and language. (2020)

- Language is the **medium** through which the entire curriculum (all subjects) is taught, learned, and assessed.
- Every subject — science, maths, social studies — requires students to **read, write, and speak** using subject-specific vocabulary and language structures.
- Weak language skills can directly **limit a student's ability to learn other subjects**, even if they understand the concept.
- Therefore, developing language skills should not be limited to language classes but should be **integrated across the curriculum**, with every teacher supporting language development in their subject.

5. Describe the differences between open-ended question and close-ended question. / What is meant by open-ended and close-ended question? Mention their advantages. (2020, 2021, 2024)

- **Open-ended questions:** have no fixed answer, encourage detailed, thoughtful responses (e.g., "Why do you think this happened?"). **Advantage:** promotes deeper thinking and expression.
- **Close-ended questions:** have a fixed, short answer, often yes/no or a specific fact (e.g., "What is the capital of India?"). **Advantage:** quick to answer and easy to assess.
- Open-ended questions are better for discussion and critical thinking; close-ended questions are better for quick recall checks and time-limited assessment.

6. What are the functions of language? (2021)

- **Communicative function:** allows people to share information, ideas, and feelings with each other.
- **Expressive function:** helps individuals express their emotions, opinions, and identity.
- **Cognitive function:** language is used for thinking, reasoning, and organizing thoughts.
- **Social function:** builds relationships and a sense of belonging to a community or culture.
- **Instructional function:** used in education to teach and transfer knowledge from teacher to student.

7. Discuss about different types of questions with examples. (2021, 2023)

- **Open-ended questions:** allow detailed answers — e.g., "How would you solve this problem differently?"
- **Closed-ended questions:** have short, fixed answers — e.g., "What is the boiling point of water?"
- **Probing questions:** dig deeper into a student's initial answer — e.g., "Can you explain why you think that?"
- **Rhetorical questions:** asked to make a point, not expecting an answer — e.g., "Isn't it important to save water?"
- **Lesson-developing questions:** guide students step by step to build understanding of a topic during the lesson.

8. Briefly describe the importance of Questioning in the classroom. (2021)

- Questioning **checks understanding** and reveals what students have or have not grasped.
- It **encourages active participation** and keeps students engaged during the lesson.
- It promotes **critical thinking and reasoning**, especially with open-ended questions.
- It helps the teacher give **immediate feedback** and correct misunderstandings early.
- It builds students' **confidence in speaking** and expressing their thoughts in class.

9. Write the basic differences between 'home language' and 'standard language'. (2021)

- **Home language** is informal, learnt naturally at home, and varies from family to family or community to community.
- **Standard language** is the formal, officially recognized version, taught in schools and used in formal writing, media, and administration.
- Home language is closely tied to a child's **emotional and cultural identity**; standard language is tied to **wider communication and formal education**.
- Home language may differ in vocabulary/pronunciation from region to region; standard language follows **uniform, fixed rules** across the wider community.

10. What are the characteristics of dialect? (2021)

- A dialect is specific to a particular **region, community, or social group**.
- It has its own **vocabulary, pronunciation, and grammar variations**, while still being related to the main language.
- Dialects are usually **mutually understandable** with the standard form of the same language.
- A dialect is often connected to a speaker's **social identity and belonging**, and is learned naturally within a community rather than formally taught.

11. What is dialect? Discuss the need of learning dialects in a classroom. (2023)

- **Dialect** is a regional or social variety of a language, differing in vocabulary, pronunciation, or grammar from the standard form.
- **Need for learning dialects in classroom:**
 - Helps teachers understand and respect the home language background of diverse students.
 - Reduces the language gap between a child's home speech and the school's standard language, easing the learning transition.

- Builds respect and inclusiveness for students who speak non-standard dialects, avoiding discrimination.
- Helps teachers use the dialect as a bridge to teach the standard language more effectively.

12. Write down the importance of 'Language across the Curriculum'. (2023)

- Recognizes that **every subject teacher is also a language teacher**, since all learning happens through language.
- Helps improve students' **reading, writing, and vocabulary skills** across all subjects, not just in language classes.
- Supports students who struggle with a subject due to **weak language skills** rather than weak subject knowledge.
- Encourages **consistent language use and correction** across the school, strengthening overall communication skills.
- Prepares students better for **exams and real-life communication**, which require strong language ability in every field.

13. Write the features of narrative text. Give one example. (2023)

- Has a clear **story structure**: beginning, middle, and end.
- Includes **characters, setting, and a plot** with events happening in sequence.
- Usually involves a **conflict or problem** that is resolved by the end.
- Uses descriptive and expressive language to engage the reader's imagination.
- **Example**: a short story about a child's adventure in a forest, describing characters, events, and how the story resolves.

14. Discuss the role of teacher in a multicultural classroom. (2022)

- The teacher should **respect and value** the different cultural backgrounds of all students.
- Use **inclusive teaching materials** and examples that represent diverse cultures, not just one dominant culture.
- Encourage students to **share their own cultural experiences**, building mutual understanding among classmates.
- Be aware of **language differences** and provide extra support for students who speak a different home language.
- Address and prevent any **discrimination or bias** based on culture, promoting a fair and welcoming classroom for all.

15. Discuss the concept of 'Power dynamics' of 'Standard language' and 'dialect'. (2022)

- The **standard language** is usually associated with education, formal institutions, media, and social prestige, giving its speakers social advantage.
- **Dialects**, though linguistically equal to standard language, are often viewed as "less correct" or lower status due to social bias, not because of any real linguistic inferiority.
- This creates a **power imbalance**, where dialect speakers may face discrimination or feel disadvantaged in formal settings like schools.
- Teachers should recognize this dynamic and avoid treating dialect-speaking students as less capable, instead valuing their language while helping them also learn the standard form.

16. Discuss the characteristics of 'language'. (2022)

- **Arbitrary**: there is no natural connection between a word and its meaning (e.g., the word "dog" does not look like a dog).
- **Systematic/rule-governed**: language follows structured grammar rules.
- **Social**: language is shared and understood within a community for communication.

- **Creative/productive:** language allows infinite new sentences to be formed from a limited set of words and rules.
- **Dynamic:** language changes and evolves over time with usage and culture.

17. Discuss the importance of Written and Oral language in the classroom. (2024)

- **Oral language:** builds immediate interaction, discussion, and quick clarification of doubts; develops listening and speaking skills essential for communication.
- **Written language:** allows students to organize thoughts more carefully, provides a permanent record for review, and develops formal, structured expression skills needed for exams and future work.
- Both work together — oral discussion often helps students prepare and think through ideas before writing them down, strengthening overall language and subject learning.

18. Discuss the role of teacher in asking questions in the classroom. (2024)

- Prepares **clear, purposeful questions** in advance, aligned with the lesson objective.
- Uses a **mix of open and closed questions** to check both recall and deeper understanding.
- Gives students **enough time (wait time)** to think before expecting an answer.
- Responds to answers with **encouraging, constructive feedback**, not harsh criticism.
- Uses **probing questions** to help students who give incomplete answers develop their thinking further.

GROUP C — 10 Marks Each (any 1 asked, ~300 words)

1. Discuss the main features of the language theory of Chomsky. / Briefly discuss the contributions of the language theory of Noam Chomsky (or Ferdinand de Saussure) to the field of language development. (2020, 2022)

Noam Chomsky, an American linguist, developed the theory of **Generative/Transformational Grammar**, which greatly influenced modern understanding of how humans acquire and use language.

Main features of Chomsky's theory:

- **Universal Grammar:** Chomsky proposed that all humans are born with an innate, biological capacity for language — a set of grammatical principles common to all human languages, present in the brain from birth.
- **Language Acquisition Device (LAD):** he suggested that children have a built-in mental mechanism (LAD) that allows them to naturally acquire the grammar of any language they are exposed to, without needing formal teaching.
- **Deep structure and surface structure:** Chomsky distinguished between the underlying meaning of a sentence (deep structure) and its actual spoken/written form (surface structure), explaining how the same meaning can be expressed in different sentence forms.
- **Generative grammar:** he argued that a finite set of grammar rules can generate an infinite number of correct, meaningful sentences, explaining human creativity in language use.
- **Critical period hypothesis (related idea):** language is best and most naturally acquired during early childhood, within a critical biological window.
- Chomsky's theory challenged earlier behaviorist views (like B.F. Skinner's), which claimed language was learned purely through imitation and reinforcement; Chomsky argued this could not explain how children create entirely new, correct sentences they have never heard before.

Contribution to language development in education: Chomsky's theory shifted focus towards understanding language learning as a natural, innate cognitive process, encouraging teaching methods that support natural language use and exposure rather than only rote drilling and repetition, and highlighting the importance of early exposure to rich language input for children.

2. Discuss the theories of language as propounded by Ferdinand De Saussure. / Discuss the language theory of Ferdinand de Saussure in the context of language development in school. (2020, 2024)

Ferdinand de Saussure, a Swiss linguist, is regarded as the **father of modern structural linguistics**. His theories laid the foundation for studying language as a structured system.

Main features of Saussure's theory:

- **Language as a system of signs:** Saussure described language as made up of "signs," each sign having two parts — the **signifier** (the sound or written form of a word) and the **signified** (the concept or meaning it represents).
- **Arbitrariness of the sign:** he argued that the connection between a signifier and its signified is arbitrary — there is no natural reason why a particular sound/word represents a particular meaning (e.g., there is nothing "tree-like" about the word "tree").
- **Langue and Parole:** Saussure distinguished between **langue** (the abstract, shared system of rules and structure of a language known by a whole speech community) and **parole** (the actual, individual use of language in speech by a person). He believed linguistics should focus on studying "langue" — the underlying system.
- **Synchronic vs Diachronic study:** he emphasized studying language as it exists at one point in time (synchronic), rather than only tracing its historical changes over time (diachronic), which was the dominant approach before him.
- **Language as a social phenomenon:** he viewed language as a shared social system, existing in the minds of a whole community, not just as an individual's private tool.

Relevance to language development in school: Saussure's ideas encourage teachers to understand language as a structured system with clear rules (grammar, vocabulary, meaning) that students need to learn systematically, while also recognizing that actual student speech (parole) will naturally vary — helping teachers balance teaching correct structure with respecting individual expression in the classroom.

3. Discuss the importance of special educational activities in language teaching. (2021)

Special educational activities — beyond standard textbook teaching — play a valuable role in developing students' language skills more effectively and enjoyably.

Types and importance of special activities:

- **Storytelling:** improves listening skills, vocabulary, and imagination; helps students understand narrative structure and sequence of events naturally.
- **Role-play and drama:** builds speaking confidence, pronunciation, and the ability to use language in different social contexts and emotional tones.
- **Debates and discussions:** develop critical thinking, argumentation skills, and the ability to express and defend opinions using appropriate language.

- **Group projects and presentations:** encourage collaborative use of language, combining speaking, writing, and research skills together.
- **Word games and puzzles (crosswords, quizzes):** make vocabulary building fun and improve spelling and word association skills.
- **Reading circles/book clubs:** encourage reading fluency, comprehension, and discussion skills through shared reading experiences.
- **Field trips and real-life language use:** connect classroom language learning to real-world communication, making learning more meaningful and practical.

Overall importance:

- These activities make language learning more **engaging and less monotonous** than only textbook-based instruction.
- They develop **all four language skills** (listening, speaking, reading, writing) in an integrated, natural way.
- They cater to **different learning styles**, helping visual, auditory, and kinesthetic learners all benefit.
- They build students' **confidence and willingness to use language** actively, rather than just passively studying grammar rules.
- Such activities also help identify and support students facing specific language difficulties, in a more relaxed, non-threatening setting than formal testing.

Conclusion: Special educational activities complement formal language instruction by making learning experiential, engaging, and better suited to developing real-world communication skills.

4. Describe the differences between 'home language' and 'school language'. (2021)

Home language is the language a child first learns and speaks naturally at home with family and community members, before or alongside formal schooling.

School language is the formal, standard language used for instruction, textbooks, and official communication within the school system — often different from a child's home language, especially in linguistically diverse regions.

Key differences:

- **Formality:** Home language is informal, casual, and used in everyday family interaction. School language is formal, follows standardized grammar rules, and is used for academic purposes.
- **Acquisition:** Home language is acquired naturally, without formal teaching, through daily interaction from infancy. School language is often formally taught through structured lessons.
- **Vocabulary:** Home language vocabulary relates to daily life, family, and immediate surroundings. School language vocabulary includes academic, subject-specific, and technical terms.
- **Variation:** Home language can vary greatly between families, regions, and communities (dialects). School language is standardized and uniform across the education system.
- **Emotional connection:** Home language is closely tied to a child's identity, culture, and emotional comfort. School language may feel more distant or "foreign" initially, especially for children whose home language differs significantly from the school's medium of instruction.
- **Purpose:** Home language serves everyday communication and cultural transmission within the family. School language serves formal learning, assessment, and wider social/economic communication.

Educational implication: A large gap between a child's home language and school language can create learning difficulties, especially in early schooling. Teachers should build bridges between the two — using the home language to support understanding while gradually developing proficiency in the school/standard language — to ensure smoother, more inclusive learning for all students.

5. What is meant by multilingualism? Discuss the features of a multicultural classroom. Discuss the role of teacher in a multicultural classroom. (2023)

Multilingualism refers to the ability of an individual or a community to understand and use more than one language. In a country like India, multilingualism is common, as many students grow up speaking their mother tongue at home, a regional language locally, and Hindi/English at school.

Features of a multicultural classroom:

- Students come from **different linguistic, religious, regional, and social backgrounds**, bringing diverse traditions and perspectives.
- There is a **variety of home languages and dialects** among students, sometimes different from the school's medium of instruction.
- Students may have **different learning styles and values** shaped by their cultural upbringing.
- There can be **varying levels of comfort and confidence** among students depending on how closely their home culture/language matches the school environment.
- A multicultural classroom offers rich opportunities for **cross-cultural learning and exchange of ideas** among students.

Role of teacher in a multicultural classroom:

- **Respect diversity:** value and acknowledge each student's cultural and linguistic background rather than expecting everyone to conform to one norm.
- **Use inclusive materials:** select textbooks, examples, and teaching aids that reflect diverse cultures, not just a single dominant one.
- **Bridge language gaps:** use students' home languages where possible to support understanding of new concepts, gradually building proficiency in the school language.
- **Encourage peer learning:** let students share their own cultural experiences and knowledge, enriching the classroom for everyone.
- **Prevent bias and discrimination:** actively watch for and address any stereotyping or unfair treatment based on culture, language, or background.
- **Flexible teaching methods:** adapt teaching style to accommodate different learning preferences shaped by students' varied cultural experiences.

Conclusion: A multicultural classroom, if managed sensitively by the teacher, can become a rich learning environment that builds not just academic knowledge but also empathy, respect, and understanding among students from different backgrounds.

6. Discuss the contributions of Bloomfield in the theory of language development. (2023)

Leonard Bloomfield was an American linguist and a key figure in the **structuralist and behaviorist approach** to language study, deeply influencing early-to-mid 20th century linguistics, especially in the United States.

Main contributions:

- **Structural approach to language:** Bloomfield emphasized studying language through its observable structure — sounds (phonology), word formation (morphology), and sentence structure (syntax) — based on scientific, objective analysis rather than speculation about meaning or mental processes.
- **Behaviorist view of language learning:** influenced by behaviorist psychology, Bloomfield believed language is learned through **habit formation** — via stimulus, response, and reinforcement — much like other learned behaviors, through repeated practice and imitation.
- **Emphasis on spoken language:** he argued that spoken language is primary and should be the main focus of linguistic study, with written language considered a secondary representation of speech.
- **Scientific/empirical methodology:** Bloomfield promoted a rigorous, data-based approach to studying language, focusing on directly observable linguistic data rather than the speaker's internal thoughts or intentions — an approach that shaped linguistics as a more "scientific" discipline.
- **Distributional analysis:** he developed methods to classify and analyze language elements (like phonemes and morphemes) based on their distribution and pattern of occurrence within speech.
- **Influence on language teaching methods:** his behaviorist ideas directly influenced language teaching approaches like the **Audio-Lingual Method**, which relies heavily on repetition, drilling, and habit formation to teach a second language.

Relevance to language development in education: Bloomfield's structural and behaviorist ideas encouraged systematic, practice-based language teaching methods, focusing on correct pronunciation, sentence patterns, and repeated practice — an approach still visible in many traditional language drills and pattern-practice exercises used in classrooms today, even though later theories (like Chomsky's) challenged the purely behaviorist explanation of language acquisition.

7. State the importance of questioning. Discuss the role of the teacher in respect to questioning in the classroom.
(2022)

Importance of Questioning:

- **Checks understanding:** questioning helps the teacher assess whether students have grasped the lesson content, revealing gaps in understanding immediately.
- **Encourages active participation:** it keeps students alert, engaged, and involved throughout the lesson, rather than passively listening.
- **Develops critical thinking:** especially open-ended and probing questions push students to reason, analyze, and form their own opinions.
- **Builds communication skills:** answering questions helps students practice organizing and expressing their thoughts clearly in language.
- **Provides feedback:** questioning allows the teacher to give immediate correction or clarification, preventing misunderstandings from continuing.
- **Motivates learning:** well-designed questions can spark curiosity and interest, making lessons more engaging and interactive.

- **Supports differentiated learning:** questions can be adjusted in difficulty to challenge or support different students according to their level.

Role of teacher in respect to questioning:

- **Preparing purposeful questions:** the teacher should plan questions in advance, aligned with the lesson's learning objectives, moving from simple to more complex.
- **Using a variety of question types:** mixing open-ended, closed-ended, and probing questions to check both factual recall and deeper understanding.
- **Giving adequate wait time:** allowing students enough time to think before answering, rather than rushing or answering for them.
- **Encouraging all students:** distributing questions fairly across the class, including quieter or less confident students, rather than relying only on eager volunteers.
- **Responding constructively:** giving encouraging, supportive feedback on answers — correcting mistakes gently without discouraging further participation.
- **Following up with probing questions:** when a student gives an incomplete or unclear answer, the teacher should ask further questions to help them develop and clarify their thinking.
- **Creating a safe environment:** ensuring students feel comfortable answering, even incorrectly, without fear of ridicule, to encourage open participation.

Conclusion: Effective questioning, guided skillfully by the teacher, is one of the most powerful classroom tools — it not only checks learning but actively drives deeper thinking, engagement, and language development among students.

8. What is Schema? Discuss about Schema in the classroom and the role of the teachers in respect to it. (2024)

Schema is an organized mental framework or structure built from a person's past knowledge, experiences, and learning, which helps them interpret, understand, and connect new information. In language and reading, schema plays a crucial role in helping students make sense of new texts by relating them to what they already know.

Schema in the classroom:

- When students encounter new content — a story, a science concept, a historical event — they use their **existing schema (prior knowledge)** to understand and interpret it.
- Students with **richer prior knowledge and experience** tend to understand and connect with new lessons more easily, since they have more schema to draw upon.
- Reading comprehension, in particular, depends heavily on schema — a student unfamiliar with the topic or cultural context of a text will struggle to fully understand it, even if they can technically read all the words.
- **New schemas** are formed, and **existing schemas are modified**, as students encounter and process new information, gradually building a more complex and organized knowledge structure over time.
- Schema also helps in **predicting and inferring** meaning while reading — students use their framework of expectations to guess what might come next in a text or lesson.

Role of the teacher in respect to schema:

- **Activating prior knowledge:** before starting a new lesson or text, the teacher should ask questions or lead discussions to bring out what students already know about the topic.

- **Building missing schema:** for topics unfamiliar to students (e.g., due to different cultural or regional backgrounds), the teacher should provide background information, pictures, videos, or real-life examples to build the necessary foundational knowledge first.
- **Connecting new to old:** the teacher should explicitly link new lesson content to previously learned material, helping students see how it fits into their existing understanding.
- **Using appropriate teaching aids:** visual aids, stories, and concrete examples help make abstract new concepts easier to fit into existing or newly forming schemas.
- **Encouraging reflection:** asking students to summarize or explain new learning in their own words helps strengthen and organize their newly formed schema.

Conclusion: Schema plays a central role in how students learn and understand language and subject content — by actively activating, building, and connecting schema, teachers can significantly improve students' comprehension, retention, and overall learning experience.

Compiled from BSAEU B.Ed. 1st Semester question papers: 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023, and 2024 (Course 1.1.4).